Lonjezo Sithole

Department of Economics, University of Michigan

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Education

University of Michigan — Ann Arbor, MI
Ph.D. Economics — 2021–present
M.A. Economics (en route to Ph.D.) — 2023

University of Edinburgh — Edinburgh, UK
MSc Econometrics, with Distinction — 2018–2019

University of Malawi — Zomba, Malawi
M.A. Economics, with Distinction — 2016–2018
BSoc.Sci Economics, Upper Second Class — 2008–2012

Fields

Primary: Econometrics
Secondary: Machine Learning, Applied Microeconomics

Working Papers

Multi-Margin Selection in Leniency Designs **Job Market Paper**

Anatomy of the First Stage with Ordered Treatments

A Locally Robust Semiparametric Approach to Examiner IV Designs
Reject & Resubmit, *Journal of Econometrics*. Awarded the 2024 Outstanding Third Year Paper Prize.

Nonparametric Testability of Slutsky Symmetry (with Florian Gunsilius)
Submitted.

Work in Progress

Semisupervised Causal Inference with Unstructured Data

Maximum Overlap Component Analysis (with Florian Gunsilius)

Presentations

Conference Presentations

Multi-Margin Selection in Leniency Designs

2026	Canadian Econometric Study Group Annual Meeting, Vancouver, Canada (Plenary)
2026	Econometric Society Australasia Meeting, Adelaide, Australia (Oral)
2026	Bristol Econometrics Study Group, Bristol, United Kingdom (Oral)
2026	Celebrating James G. MacKinnon's 75th Birthday Conference, Aarhus Center of Econometrics, Denmark (Oral, Main Program)

Last updated: October 2026

Nonparametric Testability of Slutsky Symmetry

2025	World Congress of the Econometric Society, Seoul, South Korea (Oral)
2025	International Association for Applied Econometrics Annual Conference, Turin, Italy (Oral)
2025	Canadian Econometric Study Group Annual Meeting, Ottawa, Canada (Poster)

Seminars

Fall 2026	Econometrics Seminar, University of Michigan
Winter 2026	Econometrics Student Workshop, University of Michigan
Fall 2025	Labor Lunch Seminar, University of Michigan
Summer 2025	Summer Econometrics Workshop, University of Michigan (2x)
Winter 2025	Econometrics Student Workshop, University of Michigan
Fall 2024	Labor Lunch Seminar, University of Michigan

Professional Service

Referee: *Journal of Econometrics*

Discussant: *Discrete Choice with Endogenous Peer Selection* (Kashaev & Lazzati, 2025), 2025 Canadian Econometric Study Group Annual Meeting

Teaching

Graduate Student Instructor, University of Michigan

Econ 672 (First-Year Ph.D.): Econometric Analysis II	Winter 2026
Econ 675 (Second-Year Ph.D.): Applied Microeconometrics *Also guest lecturer in both terms.*	Fall 2024, Fall 2025
Econ 504 (Master of Applied Economics): Econometrics for Applied Economics	Winter 2024
Econ 503 (Master of Applied Economics): Introduction to Probability & Statistics	Fall 2023
Econ 251 (Undergraduate): Introduction to Econometrics	Fall 2022, Winter 2023

Honors & Awards

2024	Outstanding Third Year Paper Award, University of Michigan
2019	Prize for the Best Econometrics Project, University of Edinburgh
2016	Global Young Leader, Johnson & Johnson
2012	Leader of Our Time, University of Malawi Graduating Class
2009–2010	Dean's Commendation for Best Performance, Faculty of Social Science, University of Malawi
	Defender of Academic Freedom, University of Malawi Academic Staff Union

Scholarships, Grants & Fellowships

2026–2027	Rackham Predoctoral Fellowship, University of Michigan
2026	Economics Department Travel Award, University of Michigan (May)

2025	Rackham Conference Travel Grant, University of Michigan (May and June)
2025	Economics Department Travel Award, University of Michigan (April)
2025	Lawrence Klein Fellowship in Econometrics, University of Michigan (Winter)
2021–2022	Summer Research Apprenticeships, University of Michigan
2021	William Haber Fellowship, University of Michigan
2018–2019	Beit–Edinburgh Scholarship, University of Edinburgh
2018	Bristol Graduate Excellence Scholarship (Declined)
2018	Chevening Scholarship (Declined)
2017	Chevening Scholarship (Declined)

Service & Extracurriculars

2024–Present	Advisor, Graduate International Applications Network (GAIN), University of Zurich
2022–Present	Advisor, Global Health Corps, New York
2023	Co-Founder, Black Economics Graduate Students Society, University of Michigan
2023	Department Steward, Graduate Employees Organization, University of Michigan
2022–2024	Coordinator, Graduate International Applications Network—Alumni Chapter
2022	DEI Representative, Graduate Economics Society (GES), University of Michigan
2018–2019	Program Representative, University of Edinburgh
2010–2012	President, University of Malawi Students Union

Previous Employment

World Bank, Washington, DC 2019–2021
Short-Term Consultant

Malawi National AIDS Commission, Lilongwe, Malawi 2014–2018
Monitoring & Evaluation Officer

Lighthouse Trust, Lilongwe, Malawi 2013–2014
Monitoring & Evaluation Fellow, Global Health Corps Fellowship (New York)

Professional Memberships

Econometric Society; Institute of Mathematical Statistics; European Economic Association; Economic Association of Malawi

Additional Information

Citizenship: Malawian
Software: Advanced: R, Python, Git. Intermediate: Stata, Matlab.
Languages: English (Fluent); French (A2–Beginner); Spanish (Beginner)

Dissertation Committee

Kaspar Wuthrich (Co-Chair)
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